

DSA210

Alp Erdal Çetinalp

35795

Relation Between Transfer Spending and League Success in La Liga

This project looks at a question that comes up a lot in football: does spending big in the transfer market actually lead to success on the pitch? Clubs across La Liga operate with very different financial resources, and it is not always clear whether the teams that spend the most end up finishing at the top, or whether what happens during the match matters more than what happened in the transfer window.

For the data, transfer records are sourced from a publicly available GitHub repository ([d2ski/football-transfers-data](https://github.com/d2ski/football-transfers-data)), which contains Transfermarkt data covering La Liga clubs from 2009 to 2021, including transfer fees, player market values, and transfer direction. On top of that, team performance statistics such as xG, xGA, and possession are scraped from FBref.com using Python to get a fuller picture of how clubs actually performed on the pitch. The two datasets are then merged by club and season, with any incomplete or inconsistent entries removed before analysis.

The final dataset is expected to contain around 200 club-season observations, with the target variable being each club's final points total. The analysis will begin with exploratory data analysis to identify patterns in spending and performance over time, followed by hypothesis tests to examine whether clubs that spend more statistically finish higher in the table, and finally a Random Forest model to determine whether financial investment or on-pitch metrics are the stronger predictor of league finish.